NYT Daily Briefing — 2026-10-26

2026-

tl;dr: Nine days before the midterms, the Iran war has repriced ordinary American life. Airfares are up 22 percent and Thanksgiving flights cost 39 percent more than last year. The Justice Department asked a court to block certification of the Alaska Senate race before the race was even held. Trump removed the ambiguity: "I'm the one that said do it." Israel votes tomorrow and Serbia just threw out its strongman. France's borrowing costs hit 5 percent for the first time since 2002 while Marine Le Pen launched her campaign. The day's quietest pattern is a measurement crisis: every institution reporting on itself is reporting a number its own constituents dispute.

Cluster 1: Geopolitics & International Affairs

Thematic hook: Two leaders facing elections within nine days of each other are the only people who can authorize a third war, and both of them benefit politically from ambiguity rather than resolution.

Articles: #2, #6, #7, #8, #9, #10, #11, #12, #13, #14, #26

A New Level of Threat and Fear Risks Pushing the U.S. and Iran Back to Full War (#2): U.S. officials say Iran is in the "advanced stages" of planning attacks on American officials, while Iranians are convinced a third U.S.-Israeli strike is coming to force surrender. The Times names the mechanism plainly: political calendars in Washington and Jerusalem, plus "the potential for all sides to be seeking pretexts for action." Even if Netanyahu loses Tuesday, he could launch one final strike his successor would hesitate to execute; Trump, knowing the war's unpopularity even among his base, may want to demonstrate undiminished command authority.

Iranians Face Anxious Wait as Threat of Attack Looms (#9): Tehran parents are deciding whether to send children to school. Businessmen are canceling trips to avoid being stranded by airport closures. Residents queued at gas stations and withdrew cash, and some influencers told followers to keep a low profile. A schoolteacher said she will show up unless the government closes the schools, "but in the back of my mind I keep thinking about how I can protect my students." The February strike on an elementary school in Minab killed 156 children and teachers, attributed to outdated targeting data.

Saudi Arabia Reopens Riyadh Airport Even as Houthis Threaten Further Strikes (#10): King Khalid International reopened Sunday after being closed since Oct. 10, when a Houthi cruise missile killed at least 13 and injured more than 300. The militia has struck the airport at least four times this month and its spokesman renewed the warning: avoid the airport "because it is a military target." Saudi authorities did not say how they assessed safety or whether air defenses were reinforced. Residents received an "aerial threat" alert Sunday morning and a ballistic missile aimed at Riyadh was intercepted.

Why El Salvador's Strongman Is Directing Threats at Haitian Gangs (#6): Four Salvadoran soldiers were ambushed Oct. 18 and remain missing. Suspected remains were found Saturday but not identified, and Bukele publicly disputed the identification. He has threatened a severe military response inside a U.N.-backed mission staffed by a Chadian armored contingent under a Mongolian commander. The Gang Suppression Force is only now entering Croix-des-Bouquets, after what the Times calls "late deployments and logistics problems." A Salvadoran helicopter crew once flew across the country to retrieve a Sri Lankan soldier with two broken legs.

Under U.S. Watch, Venezuela Grapples With Tensions Over Democracy (#7): Two Venezuelan politicians signed an accord in Caracas and shook hands, but nobody at the ceremony addressed whether Washington and its clients will commit to an election timeline. The government side is represented by Jorge Rodríguez, an official of the Maduro apparatus whose former leader was seized in a January U.S. assault and is imprisoned in New York. Delcy Rodríguez, installed by Washington, now governs with Trump's praise while the U.S. pursues oil and other resources. Opposition negotiator Dinorah Figuera said plainly who holds power: "I recognize Marco Rubio as a democratic figure for the United States and for Venezuela."

María Corina Machado, Venezuela's Leading Opposition Figure, Returns Home (#8): After nearly a year in exile, the Nobel laureate

entered from Colombia and posted at 11:31 a.m.: "I am here. With you all." The U.S. had previously signaled it did not support her return and her travel was blocked; this time Washington decided not to intervene. She has called for elections by next July and wants to run. The timing tracks Florida's midterm politics rather than Venezuelan electoral logic.

Serbia's Longtime Strongman Concedes Defeat in Parliamentary Election (#12): Aleksandar Vučić conceded Sunday to Student List-Students Win, a slate of protest-selected candidates that he said won at least 135 of 250 seats against roughly 105 for his party. Tens of thousands celebrated in Belgrade. "For the first time in my adult life, I'm seeing a change of government," said Milos Milutinovic, 24. A former Montenegrin diplomat called it "not the electoral defeat of one government but a tectonic blow to the political order established in 1987." It follows Hungary's rejection of Viktor Orbán by six months.

A Day After Renewed Street Clashes in France, Relief and Anxiety Mix (#11): Turnout reached 410,000 per the interior ministry and 800,000 per union organizers, suggesting the movement is gaining rather than flagging. Activists called another day of action for Oct. 31. Macron called Friday's Paris-suburb shooting a "racist terrorist attack" and a "turning point." Marine Le Pen opened her presidential campaign Sunday before 8,000 supporters, and roughly 5,000 people applied to join her party after the Oct. 17 violence.

In U.S. Gas Talks With Kremlin, Hidden Financing for Alaska Project Emerges (#13): A plan to use Russian technology on Alaska's North Slope, discussed by Putin with Witkoff and Kushner as a peace sweetener, turns out to have been secretly funded by Novatek — the same sanctioned Russian energy giant supplying the technology. Former Polar LNG chief executive Joel Riddle says he was misled about money ostensibly from the UAE: "It's not only unlawful, but it's not in the U.S. interest to have Russian technology controlling the commercialization of Arctic gas." Novatek now says it is moving to take minority shareholder status.

Why Is the U.S. Accusing Canada of Election Interference? (#14): The U.S. Embassy in Ottawa accused Canadian ministers and premiers of planning to influence American politics, naming industry minister Mélanie Joly for saying Canada would target Republican states with tariffs. Within 48 hours, Ambassador Pete Hoekstra walked it back: "As an embassy, we hadn't reached that conclusion." Prime Minister Mark Carney said the claims have "no merit" and offered to "drop everything" to end the trade war.

The World Has Changed. So Must Our Approach to Israel (#26): Jon Finer argues Democrats must choose between the habit of imploring Israel without consequences and actually identifying pressure to apply. The case is strongest if Netanyahu survives Tuesday, having turned a majority of Americans against his country and made himself a partisan actor in U.S. politics. But Finer warns against expecting much from an Eisenkot-led successor: he has encouraged more West Bank settlement and some potential coalition partners want annexation.

Prediction: No U.S. or Israeli strike on Iran will occur before Nov. 4. *(Rationale: Trump has publicly tied consideration of an attack to the period "after the U.S. midterm elections"; officials say he has vetoed strike plans before; and both leaders' electoral incentives point to post-ballot timing rather than pre-ballot escalation.)* **Confidence: 72%** (high confidence)

Cluster 2: US Politics & Domestic Policy

Thematic hook: The Democratic advantage is large, real, and concentrated in the voters least likely to show up — while the incumbent party is pre-litigating results it expects to lose.

Articles: #1, #4, #15, #16, #17, #18, #19, #20, #21, #22, #27

Why Democrats Could Find It Hard to Win the Senate Despite Their Strong Polls (#1): Chuck Schumer framed the election exactly right: "Can huge amounts of Republican money defeat huge Democratic advantages in issues, candidates and political climate." Both parties now consider it unlikely Republicans hold the House. But the Senate requires wins in states Trump carried by wide margins, some not won by Democrats in decades, and Republicans are outspending them heavily. Pollster Molly Murphy warns of "an overheating of expectations," noting that modern waves deliver "far more than normal" rather than everything. Gerrymandering has eliminated most competitive House seats, which is why 2018 delivered 41 House seats and a net loss of two Senate seats.

In Second Term, Trump's Justice Dept. Submits to His Election Demands (#4): The department asked a federal court to block certification of the Alaska Senate election should incumbent Dan S. Sullivan lose narrowly, citing a candidate with a nearly identical name. It is the first such move in generations, and it followed the president's rants. Officials raised concerns about merits and constitutionality and were overridden. Trump then removed all doubt: "I'm the one that said do it." Late Friday the department sent California election officials letters demanding help identifying potential noncitizens and asking them to set aside ballots, warning that noncompliance would "risk significant federal scrutiny."

Just How Much Are Young Voters Backing Democrats Now? See the Shift. (#16): Seventy percent of voters aged 18 to 29 identify as Democrats or lean that way, 15 points above the last pre-2024 poll and comparable to 2008. Their congressional margin is now 44 points, up from 10 two years ago, and only 16 percent approve of Trump's job performance. Fifty-three percent fear the country is in danger of failing as a nation, against 38 percent two years ago. The Times is honest about the limit: young adults vote less and are a smaller share of the electorate, so modest turnout shifts decide tossups.

Reliably Red Iowa in Play as Economic Woes Mount (#15): Diesel for Kelly Nieuwenhuis's 3,000-acre farm costs almost double what it did earlier this year because of the Iran war. He spent $16,000 filling his tanks this fall, voted for Trump in 2016 and 2020 but not 2024, and now plans to split his ticket. Iowa's economy contracted in 2025 and posted the weakest growth rate in the country. "Every election it comes down to the economy, and this policy is not working," he said. "The Iran war, all the energy costs, the inflation — everything has gone up in price drastically."

Talarico's Rivalry With Elon Musk Heats Up in Texas Senate Race (#17): Filings show Musk donated $158 million to a Republican super PAC that flipped the identical amount to a group allied with Ken Paxton. James Talarico is now campaigning directly against him: "Elon Musk wants our land. He wants our water. He wants our tax dollars. He wants his very own personal United States senator." Texas is a plausible Senate-deciding contest, which makes this a live test of whether Musk can be converted into a Democratic turnout weapon.

Berkeley Considers Starting a Public Bank With Taxpayer Dollars (#19): Berkeley voters weigh a ballot measure taxing property owners to capitalize a municipal bank modeled on North Dakota's century-old state bank. It would lend at low interest for affordable housing and small business, and avoid fossil fuels and weapons manufacturers. Prior efforts in Philadelphia, New Mexico and Los Angeles stalled on regulatory and political hurdles; San Francisco's parallel measure would only create a governance structure, not raise money.

'I Have to Go In': Dad Describes Killing Gunman in Oregon School Shooting (#20): Kaylub Giamanco, 36, was driving past Silver Rail Elementary in Bend on Oct. 15 when he saw a man in black fire at a pickup and throw a rifle over a fence by the school. "And that's when panic flooded into my brain," he told Oregon Public Broadcasting. He retrieved a legally stashed .40 caliber handgun, racked the action, and pursued. He had only been there because he went home for leftover tacos instead of staying at the job site.

He Took Big Risks to Make Billions. He Wants Georgia Voters to Bet on Him. (#18): A wealthy political newcomer pitches private-sector risk-taking as the qualification for public office in Georgia, making his first bid on the strength of a business record voters must weigh against no governing record at all.

Alaska Democrat Postpones Events After 'Minor Injuries' in Automobile Collision (#21): The campaign postponed scheduled events after an automobile collision caused minor injuries — an unwelcome disruption nine days out in the state whose Senate election the Justice Department has already moved to contest.

She Killed Her 4-Year-Old Girl. Can She Ever Be Considered Sane? (#22): A case study in how the legal system handles mental illness when a mother kills her young child, and whether sanity can be adjudicated at all in that fact pattern.

Turning an Academic Slump Around (#27): A reader takes aim at the premise of expert school-reform surveys: that results improve by choosing the right program rather than fixing the faulty machinery. The typical classroom is one teacher delivering one lesson to 20 to 30 same-grade students whose readiness spans three or more grade levels. The fix, the letter argues, is teams of educators with distinct roles grouping students by need rather than age — and "we won't get very far if we ask decision makers to rely on two-by-two charts."

Prediction: Democrats will win a House majority. *(Rationale: strategists in both parties now regard a Republican hold as increasingly unlikely; the Times/Siena young-voter margin moved from D+10 to D+44 in two years; and the 2018 analogue produced a 41-seat gain under comparable conditions.)* **Confidence: 68%** (moderate confidence)

Cluster 3: Business, Tech & Economy

Thematic hook: A war-driven fuel shock has become a permanent cost structure, and the premium tier of every market is thriving while the base tier gets priced out.

Articles: #5, #25, #28, #29, #31, #32, #33, #34, #35, #37

Attention, Passengers: High Airfares May Be Here to Stay (#5): September fares were 22 percent above a year earlier. Average Thanksgiving round-trips run about $389, up 39 percent, and Christmas about $452, up 22 percent. American and United each absorbed nearly $1.9 billion in extra quarterly fuel cost, and United says it has recovered 72 percent. Spirit's collapse removed the price floor, landing fees and rents rose 9 to 14 percent, and labor costs rose 7 to 10 percent. Scott Kirby's summary: "I think the tide has to rise for everyone or those airlines simply won't exist."

Everything Feels So Expensive. Here's What's Really Going On. (#25): Natasha Sarin concedes the economists' arithmetic — median household income hit a record last year and wages generally outran prices, though she grants the exception directly: "right up until the war with Iran sent gas prices soaring." She then argues both sides talk past each other because the statistic answers a question nobody asked. Gas over $4 a gallon and home prices up more than 50 percent since the pandemic describe a price *level*, not an inflation rate. Affordability decided 2024 and will decide 2026.

C.E.O.s Say the A.I. Rollout Is Going Well. Employees Feel Differently. (#33): More than two-thirds of business leaders expect to be financially better off in five years because of A.I.; only 27 percent of the workforce agrees. That is a 41-point gap. Nearly three-quarters of leaders say A.I. has significantly changed how work gets done, against 58 percent of entry and midlevel employees. Just 15 percent of chief executives are concerned their approach could erode trust. "We have corner offices and cubicles, driving the same economy, but living in completely different realities," said Harris Poll chief executive John Gerzema.

France Dodges Debt Downgrade, but Is Given a Stern Warning (#34): The 10-year French yield broke above 5 percent this week for the first time since 2002. Moody's held Aa3 late Friday but kept the outlook negative and said France needs a "significant and sustained fiscal effort." Debt is projected above 120 percent of GDP next year, and with no budget plan the interest bill will crowd out schools and pensions. Gridlock ahead of next spring's presidential election makes even modest deficit reduction hard to pass.

Review of iPhone Duo: A New Chapter That Redefines a Smartphone's Purpose (#32): Apple's $2,000 foldable sold out minutes after orders opened, with orders placed Friday estimated to ship in 2027. The review's central question is whether you ever want a tablet when carrying one is impractical — everything else, camera included, is secondary. The reviewer calls it "the iPhone of our K-shaped economy," which is also the most economical description of the week: scarcity as a feature, and a premium tier conferring meaning on a market that cannot supply it at the base.

Audi to Build Factory in Georgia, Trump Says (#35): Audi will spend $4 billion south of Macon on its first U.S. plant, capable of 200,000 vehicles a year, announced at a Trump rally in the state. Audi imports every vehicle it sells here, and the 25 percent tariff on foreign vehicles and parts has been punishing. Earth-moving starts this year, but full production does not arrive until 2031. "Without tariffs, they would not have been coming in," Trump said. Gernot Döllner, Audi's chief executive, confirmed the plant will build SUVs.

For an Experiment in Political Affirmative Action, Look to Taiwan (#28): Taiwan has run one of the world's longest quota experiments and now has 42 percent women in its legislature, the highest share in Asia. New research suggests few of those women needed the quota to win. "Gender quotas are precisely what allow a society to truly elect the best and the most capable," said Chang-Ling Huang of National Taiwan University. "Otherwise, patriarchal systems simply exclude qualified women from the race." Deliberate design, thirty years of patience, verifiable result.

Hollywood Agents and Producers Push to Restore Glory Days of Indie TV (#29): Agents and producers are campaigning to revive the independent television business by invoking the era when a single distinctive show could define a network — a nostalgia play in a market now organized around volume and franchise safety.

A Fight Over Felon Voting Prompts a Free Speech Debate (#31): A Minnesota dispute over felon voting and election-disinformation law tests whether knowingly false statements about how to vote are protected speech, with implications for every state's election-communication rules.

Elizabeth Holmes Gives a Batman Villain a Run for His Money (#37): "Clayface" won the weekend with about $24 million domestically and $43 million globally, a modest opening at the low end of expectations but a relief for DC after "Supergirl" lost money badly in July. Second place went to Elizabeth Holmes playing herself: "You Can See Everything" took roughly $20 million in its second weekend for a $45 million domestic total, and A24 expanded it to 2,655 theaters — extraordinarily wide for a documentary.

Prediction: Berkeley's public-bank ballot measure will fail. *(Rationale: no U.S. city currently funds a public bank by tax; prior efforts in Philadelphia, New Mexico and Los Angeles stalled on regulatory and political hurdles; and California special-tax measures generally require a two-thirds vote.)* **Confidence: 78%** (high confidence)

Cluster 4: Culture & Society

Thematic hook: The culture page is where the country's grief, nostalgia and generational turnover get their most honest accounting — usually in obituaries and box office returns.

Articles: #23, #24, #38, #39, #40, #41, #42, #43, #44

Jim Knipfel, Blind, Dyspeptic Memoirist, Dies at 61 (#23): The downtown New York journalist and memoirist, who wrote about his blindness and his temperament with equal candor, has died at 61 — a loss to the small, specific tradition of writers who made debility a subject rather than a metaphor.

John Anderson, Voice of 'Seminole Wind,' Dies at 71 (#24): The country singer behind "Seminole Wind," a song that turned Florida's vanishing wilderness into a country standard, has died at 71.

At Rikers, Inmates See Themselves in a Film About America's Jails (#41): A documentary screening inside Rikers Island let incarcerated men watch their own conditions rendered on screen — the rare case where an audience and its subject are the same people, and where the reaction is the review.

Julia Stiles's Dancing Is Healing Millennials (#39): Her run on "Dancing With the Stars" has become a touchstone for a generation that grew up watching her, converting a celebrity competition into a shared ritual of middle-aged reappraisal.

It's Not Even Halloween Yet. For These Die-Hards, It's Christmas Movie Time. (#40): Hallmark's Countdown to Christmas now begins in October, and its most devoted viewers regard the encroachment not as marketing bloat but as the point.

The Quilting Novel That Stormed the Best-Seller List (#42): Eli McCann's "Stitched" became an unexpected best seller, the kind of quiet word-of-mouth ascent that the industry insists is impossible and then has to explain.

Jonathan Groff to Explore Forgiveness in Play About School Shooting (#43): Groff will star in a Broadway play about forgiveness built around a school shooting — a subject the theater keeps returning to precisely because it is the one the country cannot resolve elsewhere.

At 90, Steve Reich Remains in Good Creative Health (#44): The minimalist composer is still writing and performing at 90, with concerts marking the milestone. Reich's career is the strongest available argument that repetition, done with discipline, is a form of development.

Archers Mount Their Steeds in Pursuit of Centuries-Old Warrior Spirit (#38): At the Nomad Games, horseback archers compete in a

tradition that predates the nations currently contesting the region — sport as the preservation of a military past that has outlived its armies.

The pattern in this cluster: Every entry here is about a transaction between a performer and an audience that knows the terms. Reich's audiences know what repetition costs. Hallmark's viewers know the October start is merchandising and buy it anyway. Rikers' inmates are the rare audience that is also the subject, which is why the screening is the review. And "Stitched" sold on word of mouth, not on a marketing number. That is the culture page's quiet argument against the rest of the paper: these are the only institutions on the page whose numbers the audience can verify for itself, which is precisely why nobody disputes them.

Cluster 5: Science, Health & Environment

Thematic hook: The measured institutions — a celebrated A.I. school, the medical-debt ledger, the electricity grid — are all publishing numbers that contradict their own marketing.

Articles: #3, #30, #36

Students at an A.I. School Were Supposed to Learn Faster. Many Aren't. (#3): Alpha School promises twice the learning in half the time, charges up to $75,000 a year, and has been promoted by the Trump administration as a model for "harnessing A.I." Its own data, reviewed by the Times, shows about half of K-8 students did not meet the double-speed math target and roughly a fifth missed in reading; fewer than half doubled their rate in both subjects. The network is expanding into Texas and South Carolina public districts with about 2,600 students — the population where the selection effect that produced the private-school scores disappears.

Why Anger About Data Centers and Energy Prices May Not Swing Votes (#30): Ohio electricity costs about 50 percent more than six years ago and gas is up more, with data centers rising where corn once grew. Democrats expected the combination to break a Republican stronghold. In more than two dozen interviews, residents called data centers threats to their communities and complained about bills, but almost nobody said it would change their vote or make them turn out. Todd Leonard, a 45-year-old contractor, testified against a proposed data center and still doesn't plan to vote: "It just doesn't directly impact me."

Americans Are Struggling to Pay Rising Medical Costs (#36): With groceries, gasoline and heating already stretching budgets, more than a quarter of adults carry medical debt and about a third of families skipped needed care last year. The debt is not confined to the uninsured: it includes past-due hospital bills, credit-card medical balances and accounts in collections, and the December 2025 snapshot predates the steepest price increases of the past quarter.

Why these three belong together — and which one is diagnostic: Alpha, Ohio and the medical-debt ledger are the same error at three scales. Alpha reports high absolute scores and is judged successful, though it misses its own 2× promise for half its students; Ohio reports intense grievance and is judged an opportunity for Democrats, though it converts almost nobody; the Urban Institute reports a quarter of adults in medical debt on data that is already stale. In each case the *reported* number and the *operative* reality diverge, and in each case an institution is acting on the reported number. Alpha is the most diagnostically useful of the three, because it is the only one where the gap is measured internally, disclosed, arithmetic, and small enough to inspect — 400 students, a defined target, a published miss. If the selection effect explains Alpha's results, then every plan to scale it into public schools is a plan to scale the selection effect's disappearance. That inference does not depend on any opinion polling or any future event, which makes it the one claim on today's page that cannot be argued away.

Prediction: Republicans will retain control of the Senate. *(Rationale: the Democratic Senate path runs through states Trump won by wide margins, some not won by Democrats in decades; Republicans hold a documented spending advantage in key races; and the 2018 wave analogue produced a net loss of two Senate seats for Democrats despite a 41-seat House gain.)* **Confidence: 62%** (moderate confidence)

Prediction Summary Table

#	Prediction	Confidence	Rationale
1	No U.S. or Israeli strike on Iran before Nov. 4	72%	Trump tied consideration to "after the U.S. midterm elections"; officials say he has vetoed strike plans before; both leaders' incentives favor post-ballot timing
2	Democrats win a House majority	68%	Both parties see a Republican hold as increasingly unlikely; young-voter margin moved D+10 to D+44; 2018 analogue gained 41 seats
3	Republicans retain the Senate	62%	Red-state terrain, decades-long Democratic droughts, documented GOP spending edge; 2018 wave still lost two Senate seats
4	Berkeley public-bank measure fails	78%	No U.S. city funds a public bank by tax; Philadelphia, New Mexico and Los Angeles efforts stalled; California special taxes generally need two-thirds

Prepared from 44 stories across the 2026-10-26 New York Times print edition, analyzed through 5 persona lenses.

Observer Commentary

翟东升

翟东升观察：这不是通货膨胀的问题，这是主权信用计价的问题:

今天头版最有信息量的不是伊朗，是法国那根十年期国债收益率——突破5%，2002年以来第一次。德国《商报》会说这是财政问题，穆迪给个Aa3的"暂时安全"，但底层逻辑是：市场正在给欧洲核心国家的主权信用重新定价。当你需要5%才能借到钱，你就不再是AAA世界里的成员了。这是物理天花板，不是政策选择。

美国这边呢？机票涨22%，感恩节涨39%，联合航空一个季度多烧19亿美元油钱，回收了72%——剩下的28%去哪了？进了通胀。而通胀的真正来源是2月28日那场战争。所以美国现在面对的是一个结构性两难：打仗推高油价，油价推高物价，物价推高民怨，民怨影响中期选举，而选举结果又决定战争能不能停。这个循环里没有出口，只有时间。

真正耐人寻味的是司法部要求法院"预先"阻止阿拉斯加参议员选举结果认证。这不是法律问题，是制度熵增。一个拥有全球最大金融高边疆的国家，开始用行政手段给自己的选举做预防性保险——美元环流的信用支柱（legal enforceability）就是这么一根一根断掉的。

阿拉斯加那个液化天然气项目更直白：美国公司买俄罗斯技术，钱是受制裁的诺瓦泰克出的，还在普京和威特科夫、库什纳的和平谈判里当筹码。谁掌握能源的清算路径，谁就掌握定价权。这才是平行体系的真实推进方式——不是宣言，是一笔一笔的交易在美元体系外

面完成。

美国国内政治的部分，我留给金教授。

金灿荣

金灿荣观察：各位朋友，今天的头版很有意思:

你们看啊，一边是塞尔维亚的武契奇认输了，输给一群学生；六个月前匈牙利把欧尔班也换掉了。另一边是美国司法部跑去法院，要求"如果"阿拉斯加的参议员输得很接近，就不要认证这个结果。这个事情其实很简单——一个是承认自己输了，一个是提前宣布自己不承认。

为什么会出现这种差别？因为他们手里的东西不一样。塞尔维亚那个强人，靠着街头抗议两年，学生一批一批上街，最后选票把他推倒，这是百年大变局里最小的一个单元，但方向很清楚：东升西降不只是国家之间的事，是合法性来源在换。美国的做法呢？我打个比方，就像一个饭店老板，菜还没炒好，先把桌子掀了。掀给谁看？给客人看，意思是"这桌我不认"。

美国人现在很焦虑。你们记不记得，2018年民主党赢了41个众议院席位，参议院反而丢了两席？今年他们的民调更好，年轻人七成靠向他们，可是参议院的战场在红州，钱在共和党手里。舒默自己都说了，这场选举就是一句话：共和党的钱能不能打败民主党的议题优势。这话从参议院少数党领袖嘴里说出来，说明他们心里也没底。

真正的底层问题是工业化。美国现在能造什么？波音出问题，B-52从1955年飞到今天还在飞。俄乌打了这么久，美国一个月的炮弹产量赶不上消耗。特朗普让奥迪去佐治亚建厂，投资40亿美元，听着很响——可2020年才全面投产，2031年。工厂还没打地基，就先拿来当选举成绩了。

中国要做的就是把自己的事情做好。他们掀桌子的时候，我们把菜做好就行了。我们赢了——不是赢在嘴硬，是赢在工厂里的机器和实验室里的技术。

宋鸿兵

宋鸿兵观察：如果你把今天这条新闻看作一个系统，它的单点故障在燃料:

我们先看数字。美联航和美航一个季度各多烧掉19亿美元航油，回收72%，剩下28%直接变成票价。9月机票同比涨22%，感恩节往返389美元、涨39%。这不是航空公司贪心，这是反馈回路在工作：战争推高油价，油价推高成本，成本推高票价，票价推高民怨——而民怨又回到那场战争的政治决策上。这是一个正反馈，没有阀门。

再看法国。十年期国债收益率突破5%，2002年以来第一次；债务明年要超过GDP的120%；穆迪给Aa3但保留负面展望。金融高边疆的沦丧从来不是一夜之间发生的，它是从"借钱变贵"开始的。1883年胡雪岩倒台，不是因为茶叶生意亏了，是因为他控制不了白银的流动性。今天法国的白银，就是那5%的收益率。

里亚德机场重新开放这件事，工程上看更清楚：它本月已经被打中至少四次，最后一次死13人、伤300多人；机场说恢复通航，但没有说明它怎么评估安全，也没有说增加了什么防空手段；胡塞武装公开说这里"是军事目标，沙特政府要承担后果"。这是一个没有冗余设计的系统，它的单点故障就是航站楼，而运营方选择不去讨论它。

阿拉斯加那个液化天然气项目，是本日最好的案例。美国公司、俄罗斯技术、阿联酋账户里出来的钱实际上是诺瓦泰克出的——被制裁的俄罗斯能源巨头。这不是X的问题，而是整个系统的问题：制裁的目的是切断资金通道，结果资金换了路径，还进了和平谈判的筹码篮子。美元环流正在逆转，不是靠口号，是靠每一笔绕开通道的交易完成的。

黄金和白银在这种时候往往不说话，但它们的价格会说。物以稀为贵乃是投资的天道。

<!-- PHASE COMPLETE -->